

1.4 The Future

1.4.1 Proprietary Software

According to Stallman, fixing a software should not be seen as different from fixing a water tap. Ordinary people should be able to do it with little effort. The OSS movement has ensured that users will be more aware of the pitfalls of using proprietary software, whether free or not. With OSS, ordinary people can collaborate and share software with others without feeling guilty or being labelled a pirate or being paranoid about being penalised. Using OSS will ensure that the general awareness among users will increase, since they will be able to identify and debug code without waiting to be spoon-fed by a vendor.

1.4.2 GNU/LINUX

The GNU Project is continuing to work on the HURD kernel to complete the GNU OS. But whether it will gain the wide acceptance that GNU/Linux has is anybody's guess. Nevertheless, given the inherent advantages of an OSS, compatibility and price will not be issues.

1.4.3 The personal Desktop arena

Unlike commercial usage, where stability is more important than a slick GUI, the non-commercial PC requires greater user-friendliness and a greater variety of entertainment software like games. OSS games are presently few and far between. Many OSS programs have been made available for proprietary OSes. The first step to accepting OSS is to switch to these applications.